

BTEC Level 3 Health and Social Care

Unit 2: Working in Health and Social Care

Exam Walkthrough | Paper 31491H | Session: June 2017

How to answer every question · step by step

Command words · what the examiner wants

Identify / State (2 marks) · Give TWO brief, correct points. No explanation needed · just name or state two relevant things. 1 mark per point.

Describe (4 marks) · Give TWO points, each with a little detail. Two developed points = 4 marks (2 marks each).

Explain (6 marks) · Give THREE points, each explained (a point + a reason or effect). Three developed points = 6 marks (2 marks each).

Discuss (8 marks) · Give a BALANCED argument: several developed points PLUS a 'however' counterpoint. Four developed points = 8 marks (2 marks each).

Question 1 (a)

Identify two other health and social care settings that could provide Charlotte's care. (2)

Command word: Identify

How to approach: This is a simple recall question. 'Settings' means the places or organisations where care is delivered. Charlotte is receiving cancer care, so think of the range of places a person with a serious illness might receive support · not just a hospital.

Model answer:

- Hospital.
- Hospice / care home / GP surgery (any two).

Why it earns the marks: One mark for each correct setting. Any two valid health and social care settings earn the full 2 marks · you do not need to explain them.

Question 1 (b)

Describe two issues that could have affected Charlotte's access to services for her cancer care. (4)

Command word: Describe

How to approach: 'Issues' here means barriers. Think about the different types of barrier (financial, geographical, physical, communication) and pick two, then add a short detail about HOW each one affects access.

Model answer:

- Financial barriers · the cost of travel or treatment may have limited her access.
- Geographical barriers · distance or lack of transport to specialist services may have delayed access.

Why it earns the marks: Two marks per barrier: one for naming the barrier, one for describing its effect. Naming 'financial barriers' alone is only worth 1 mark · you must add the detail.

Question 1 (c)

Explain how Susie, the cancer support nurse, could empower her service users. (6)

Command word: Explain

How to approach: 'Empower' means giving people control over their own care. Think of three concrete ways a nurse can do this · involving them in decisions, giving information, and promoting their rights and confidence.

Model answer:

- Involving service users in decisions about their care and respecting their choices.
- Providing information and support so they can make informed decisions.
- Promoting their rights, dignity and independence, and building their confidence.

Why it earns the marks: Three developed points, 2 marks each. Each point states an action AND its purpose/effect · that is what turns a simple statement into an 'explain'.

Question 1 (d)

Discuss how Susie, the cancer support nurse, could ensure her own personal safety when working with Charlotte at her home. (8)

Command word: Discuss

How to approach: This is about lone working and personal safety. Give three practical safety measures, then add a 'however' point showing balance (e.g. safety also depends on the organisation).

Model answer:

- Following lone-working procedures, such as informing colleagues of her whereabouts and expected return.
- Carrying out a risk assessment of the home environment before visits.
- Following personal safety procedures and having a means of raising the alarm if needed.
- However, safety also depends on the organisation providing adequate support and training, and Susie following procedures consistently.

Why it earns the marks: Four developed points at 2 marks each. The 'however' point is essential for a Discuss · it shows you can weigh both sides and is what lifts the answer to full marks.

Question 2 (a)

Identify two ways that Beth could support John so he can cope at work. (2)

Command word: Identify

How to approach: John is a service user who needs support to cope at work. Think of two practical ways an employer or care manager can help someone stay in work.

Model answer:

- Making reasonable adjustments to John's role or workplace.
- Providing support and advice / flexible working (any two).

Why it earns the marks: One mark per correct point. Two brief, valid ways earn the full 2 marks.

Question 2 (b)

Describe how two policies protect vulnerable individuals such as John within the residential care setting. (4)

Command word: Describe

How to approach: Name two specific policies (safeguarding, health and safety, equality, confidentiality) and describe HOW each one protects a vulnerable person.

Model answer:

- Safeguarding policy · protects John from abuse and harm by setting out procedures for reporting and responding to concerns.
- Health and safety policy · protects John from accidents and hazards through risk assessments and safe working practices.

Why it earns the marks: Two marks per policy: one for naming it, one for describing how it protects. Linking the policy to protection (not just naming it) is what earns the second mark.

Question 2 (c)

Explain how the staff in the residential unit could prevent discrimination towards its service users. (6)

Command word: Explain

How to approach: Think of three ways staff can actively prevent discrimination · treating people equally, challenging discrimination, and training/adapting care.

Model answer:

- Treating all service users fairly and equally, regardless of their characteristics.
- Challenging any discriminatory attitudes or behaviour from staff or others.
- Providing training on equality and diversity and adapting care to meet individual needs.

Why it earns the marks: Three developed points, 2 marks each. Each point gives an action and its purpose, which is what 'explain' requires.

Question 2 (d)

Discuss Beth's other responsibilities towards her staff as a care manager. (8)

Command word: Discuss

How to approach: Beth is a care manager, so think about her duties to her STAFF (not service users) · safety, training/supervision, and fair management · then add a 'however' about the pressures of the role.

Model answer:

- Providing a safe working environment and following health and safety legislation.
- Providing training, supervision and support so staff can carry out their roles effectively.
- Managing staff fairly, including recruitment, appraisal and addressing concerns or grievances.
- However, these responsibilities require time and resources, and Beth must balance staff needs with the needs of service users and the organisation.

Why it earns the marks: Four developed points at 2 marks each. The 'however' point shows balance and is required for a full-mark Discuss answer.

Question 3 (a)

Identify two ways Aziz's family could pursue his complaint against the GP. (2)

Command word: Identify

How to approach: Think of the formal routes for making a complaint about a GP · the practice's own procedure, and external bodies like the ombudsman or regulator.

Model answer:

- Using the GP practice's complaints procedure.
- Contacting the ombudsman / regulatory body (any two).

Why it earns the marks: One mark per correct route. Two valid complaint routes earn the full 2 marks.

Question 3 (b)

Describe the roles of two organisations that regulate or inspect health and social care services. (4)

Command word: Describe

How to approach: Name two regulatory/inspection bodies (CQC, professional bodies like GMC/NMC) and describe what each one actually does.

Model answer:

- The Care Quality Commission (CQC) inspects and regulates health and social care services in England to ensure they meet standards.
- Professional bodies (e.g. GMC, NMC) regulate individual professionals, setting standards and investigating complaints.

Why it earns the marks: Two marks per organisation: one for naming it, one for describing its role. Be specific about what each body does.

Question 3 (c)

Explain how Aziz's social worker could support him to manage the effects of his blindness. (6)

Command word: Explain

How to approach: Aziz is blind, so think of three ways a social worker can help him live independently · assessing needs, referring to specialist services, and providing emotional support.

Model answer:

- Assessing Aziz's needs and arranging support and adaptations to help him live independently.
- Referring Aziz to specialist services (e.g. sensory impairment teams, charities) for additional support.
- Providing emotional support and empowering Aziz to maintain his independence and wellbeing.

Why it earns the marks: Three developed points, 2 marks each. Each point links an action to its effect on Aziz's independence and wellbeing.

Question 3 (d)

Discuss the responsibilities health and social care professionals have to help Aziz to reach his goals. (8)

Command word: Discuss

How to approach: Think of three ways professionals help someone reach their goals (partnership, providing support/resources, reviewing progress), then add a 'however' about balancing goals with safety and resources.

Model answer:

- Working in partnership with Aziz to set realistic, person-centred goals based on his wishes.
- Providing the support, information and resources needed to help Aziz achieve his goals.
- Reviewing progress and adjusting support as Aziz's needs change.
- However, professionals must balance Aziz's goals with what is safe and achievable within available resources, and avoid imposing their own views.

Why it earns the marks: Four developed points at 2 marks each. The 'however' point (balancing goals with safety/resources) is the balanced element a Discuss needs.

Question 4 (a)

Identify two physical needs that you might assess. (2)

Command word: Identify

How to approach: Physical needs are basic bodily needs. Think of two · mobility, nutrition, personal care, medication.

Model answer:

- Mobility.
- Nutrition / personal care / medication (any two).

Why it earns the marks: One mark per correct physical need. Two valid needs earn the full 2 marks.

Question 4 (b)

Describe two professional skills, other than assessment, you may need when working with someone like Tom. (4)

Command word: Describe

How to approach: Tom is a service user, so think of two interpersonal skills (communication, empathy, patience) and describe each one briefly.

Model answer:

- Communication skills · listening and explaining clearly to build trust and understanding.
- Empathy · understanding and responding sensitively to Tom's feelings and needs.

Why it earns the marks: Two marks per skill: one for naming it, one for describing how it helps. Note the question excludes 'assessment', so do not use that.

Question 4 (c)

Explain how a hospital could make sure that you have the skills to meet the National Occupational Standards. (6)

Command word: Explain

How to approach: Think of three ways an employer ensures staff meet standards · training, monitoring/supervision, and using standards in recruitment/appraisal.

Model answer:

- Providing training so staff understand and can meet the required standards.
- Monitoring and supervising staff performance against the standards.
- Using the standards in recruitment, appraisal and CPD to maintain competence.

Why it earns the marks: Three developed points, 2 marks each. Each point states a method and its purpose in meeting the standards.

Question 4 (d)

Discuss how multidisciplinary working could effectively support both Tom and Linda. (8)

Command word: Discuss

How to approach: Give three benefits of multidisciplinary working (holistic care, coordination, better outcomes), then a 'however' about the challenges (time, communication).

Model answer:

- Multidisciplinary working brings together different expertise so Tom and Linda's needs are considered holistically.
- It improves coordination and consistency, with professionals sharing information and working towards shared goals.
- It can lead to better outcomes as each aspect of their support is addressed by a specialist.
- However, it can be time-consuming and may involve communication difficulties or disagreements, which need to be managed through clear communication and shared records.

Why it earns the marks: Four developed points at 2 marks each. The 'however' point (challenges of MDT working) provides the balance a Discuss requires.
